

# AI-Powered Grant Fit Scorecard

## Evaluate opportunities before investing hours in a proposal.

Use verified evidence to score grant fit consistently and document a clear Pursue, Monitor, or Decline decision.

### Opportunity Snapshot

|                      |                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------|
| Organization         | Grant opportunity     |
| <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>  |
| Funder               | Primary-source link   |
| <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>  |
| Deadline             | Award amount or range |
| <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>  |
| Date reviewed        | Reviewer              |
| <input type="text"/> | <input type="text"/>  |

### Eligibility Screen

**STOP RULE: If any answer is No, do not proceed until the issue is resolved and verified in the primary grant source.**

|   |                                                         |     |    |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------|-----|----|
| 1 | The applicant type and legal status are eligible.       | Yes | No |
| 2 | The geographic area and population served are eligible. | Yes | No |
| 3 | The proposed activities and use of funds are allowable. | Yes | No |
| 4 | The deadline and all mandatory requirements can be met. | Yes | No |

**Scoring formula**  
Rate each criterion from 0 to 5. Weighted score = rating / 5 x weight. The six weights total 100 points.

# Weighted Evaluation

Score only what can be supported by credible evidence. Verify grant details using the funder's official source.

## Criterion 1: Eligibility and Compliance

Weight: 20

- Does the organization meet every applicant eligibility requirement?
- Are the proposed activities, costs, and service area allowable?
- Can all mandatory documents, registrations, and assurances be completed on time?

Rating (0-5)

Weighted score (0-20)

Evidence, primary source, and notes

Use 0 = no fit, 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = moderate, 4 = strong, 5 = excellent.

## Criterion 2: Mission and Program Alignment

Weight: 20

- Does the opportunity directly support the organization's mission and strategic priorities?
- Does the proposed program clearly match the funder's stated purpose?
- Would the organization pursue this work even without this specific grant?

Rating (0-5)

Weighted score (0-20)

Evidence, primary source, and notes

Use 0 = no fit, 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = moderate, 4 = strong, 5 = excellent.

## Criterion 3: Population and Geographic Fit

Weight: 15

- Do the people served match the funder's priority population?
- Is the proposed service area eligible and competitive?
- Can the organization document community need with credible data?

Rating (0-5)

Weighted score (0-15)

Evidence, primary source, and notes

Use 0 = no fit, 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = moderate, 4 = strong, 5 = excellent.

## Weighted Evaluation - Continued

Score only what can be supported by credible evidence. Verify grant details using the funder's official source.

### Criterion 4: Funder Priorities and Relationship

Weight: 15

- Does the project align with current funding priorities and recent awards?
- Is there evidence that the funder supports organizations or programs like this one?
- Is there an existing relationship, referral, invitation, or realistic path to engagement?

Rating (0-5)

Weighted score (0-15)

Evidence, primary source, and notes

Use 0 = no fit, 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = moderate, 4 = strong, 5 = excellent.

### Criterion 5: Readiness and Competitiveness

Weight: 15

- Are leadership, staff, partners, and systems ready to deliver the project?
- Can the organization demonstrate relevant outcomes, experience, and community trust?
- Is the proposal likely to stand out against expected competition?

Rating (0-5)

Weighted score (0-15)

Evidence, primary source, and notes

Use 0 = no fit, 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = moderate, 4 = strong, 5 = excellent.

### Criterion 6: Financial Value and Application Feasibility

Weight: 15

- Is the award large enough to justify the application and reporting effort?
- Are match requirements, restrictions, payment timing, and indirect costs manageable?
- Can a strong, accurate proposal be completed by the deadline without disrupting priorities?

Rating (0-5)

Weighted score (0-15)

Evidence, primary source, and notes

Use 0 = no fit, 1 = very weak, 2 = weak, 3 = moderate, 4 = strong, 5 = excellent.

# Decision Summary

## Calculated Result

Total weighted score (0-100)

Score-based recommendation

**PURSUE**

75-100

**MONITOR**

50-74

**DECLINE**

0-49

## Final Recommendation

**Pursue**

**Monitor**

**Decline**

Decision rationale

Risks or unresolved questions

## Next Step

Immediate action

Owner

Target date

Primary-source verification needed

### AI Analysis Prompt

Act as an experienced nonprofit Grant Strategy Director. Analyze this completed Grant Fit Scorecard. Confirm the math, identify missing evidence, flag eligibility or deadline risk, and recommend Pursue, Monitor, or Decline. Explain the three strongest reasons. Do not invent facts. Label anything requiring verification and rely on the funder's primary source for eligibility, deadline, award amount, and application requirements.

**AI supports analysis; it does not replace primary-source verification.**